Nickolas Diaz

Dr. Patrick Luck

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Response for the Cold War

This discussion will talk about the fear that the cold war gave the Americans in the texts of “Joseph McCarthy on Communism (1950)” and the video of “Duck and Cover”. Starting off the video of demonstrating children what to do if an atomic bomb was dropped near them. It represents an idea that at any point of time everyone and everything can be destroyed in a matter of seconds. Having the constant threat of nuclear destruction without having any idea what is going on in the world would absolutely be nerve racking to Americans. Joseph McCarthy, having similar fear, says in his speech that the cold war is a fight between communism, atheism and christianity, the very values that Americans depend upon can be destroyed through similar situations that happened in WW2 with Germany (Nazis) and Japan. He argues that US intervention in other countries is absolutely necessary to stop another world war. This is a contradiction of American isolationism where the thought process of we are completely safe if we keep to ourselves is not true anymore. Lastly on paranoia McCarthy states that the very threats that can instantly destroy the US are already within ourselves, claiming 57 identified individuals who are loyal to communism and are within the government making of foreign policy decisions. American paranoia during the cold war represents the constant threat of destroying everything, buildings, families, and American ideals, and the threat is already inside the government, and to top it off, the people have no little what is happening in the world.